Mouton's Bistro & Bar
Kitchen Staff Policy
and TrainingManual
Mouton's

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Kitchen Staff Policy and Training Manual

Effective Date: May 20, 2025

Welcome to Mouton's Bistro & Bar Kitchen Team

Welcome to the kitchen team at Mouton's Bistro & Bar, where Southern culinary tradition meets excellence. As a key contributor, you ensure every dish embodies our "Fast and Flavorful" motto. This manual outlines policies, procedures, and a comprehensive training program to prepare you for success. Let's cook with passion and precision!

Note: This manual applies to Mouton's Bistro & Bar (Cedar Park) only, as the Leander location closed on May 20, 2025.

About Mouton's Bistro & Bar

Mission Statement

At Mouton's Bistro & Bar, we are dedicated to:

- Delivering exceptional dining experiences through culinary excellence.
- Treating guests as family and our team with respect.
- Sharing expertise honed through dedication and hard work.
- Measuring success by guest satisfaction and dish quality.
- Supporting our kitchen staff to thrive under pressure.

Location and Hours

Mouton's Bistro & Bar (Cedar Park)

- **Address:** 1821 S. Lakeline Blvd #104, Cedar Park, TX 78613
- **Phone:** (512) 356-9300
- **Hours:** Monday–Sunday, 8:00 AM–9:00 PM
- **Brunch:** Monday–Friday, 8:00 AM–11:00 AM; Saturday–Sunday, 8:00 AM–2:00 PM
- **Website:** www.moutonsbistro.com

Kitchen Roles and Hierarchy

Staff Structure

- **Executive Chef (Ric Gonzales):** Oversees all kitchen operations, recipe development, and staff training.
- **Sous Chef (Line Cooks):** Supports the Executive Chef, manages daily production, and supervises line cooks.
- **Prep Cooks, Dishwashers:** Assist with ingredient preparation and cleaning under the Sous Chef's direction.
- **Kitchen Manager (Dion Vasquez):** Manages operational oversight.

Supervision and Staffing

- The Executive Chef oversees all staff, with the Kitchen Manager and Sous Chef handling daily supervision.
- Typically, 5 staff members are on duty per shift during dinner, with 1 on each station (expo, sauté, fry, salad, dish).

Kitchen Staff Job Description

Primary Responsibility

Prepare, cook, and plate high-quality Southern dishes per Mouton's recipes, ensuring timely service, food safety, and a clean kitchen.

Essential Functions

- **Food Preparation:** Execute recipes and prep ingredients with precision.
- **Health and Safety:** Comply with Texas food safety laws and protocols.
- **Teamwork:** Collaborate with kitchen and front-of-house staff.
- **Cleanliness:** Maintain sanitized workstations using "clean as you go."
- **Equipment Use:** Operate tools safely, reporting issues promptly.

Expectations

Uphold the "Fast and Flavorful" motto with quality, efficiency, and professionalism.

Kitchen Staff Uniform Standards

Attire Requirements

- **Tops:** Clean, black chef coats or utility shirts are required.
- **Bottoms:** Black or non-slip shoes; no shorts allowed, legs fully covered.
- **Footwear:** Non-slip, closed-toe shoes are mandatory.
- **Headwear/Gloves:** Hairnets or hats and gloves provided and required.
- **Aprons:** Clean aprons must be worn and tied securely.

Presentation

Adherence ensures safety and professionalism.

- **Policy on Jewelry:** Adhere to Texas restaurant requirements (no rings, watches).
- **Inspection:** Uniforms inspected weekly; must be laundered after each shift.
- **Photo Example:** [Insert photo of proper uniform here – please provide.]

Training Program

Purpose

This 7-day training program (6–8 hours per shift) prepares you for independent duties, focusing on recipes, safety, and station mastery.

Training Progress Tracker

- **Trainee Name:** _____
- **Start Date:** _____
- **Trainer Name:** _____

Completion Milestones

1. **Day 1: Orientation and Safety**
   - Date: _____ | Initials: _____
2. **Day 2: Prep and Inventory**
   - Date: _____ | Initials: _____
3. **Day 3: Cooking Stations**
   - Date: _____ | Initials: _____
4. **Day 4: Advanced Techniques**
   - Date: _____ | Initials: _____
5. **Day 5: Event Prep**
   - Date: _____ | Initials: _____
6. **Day 6: Team Coordination**
   - Date: _____ | Initials: _____
7. **Day 7: Final Evaluation**
   - Final Approval Date: _____ | Signature: _____

Training Schedule

Day 1: Orientation and Safety

Objective: Introduce kitchen layout, safety, and roles.
Duration: 6–8 Hours
Key Components:

- Welcome and team introductions.
- Tour: grill, sauté, fry, salad, prep, walk-in coolers, dish area.
- Safety: handwashing (20 seconds), Texas Food Handler's Permit (within 30 days), 40°F cold, 165°F hot.
- Equipment: griddles, fryers, ovens, knives.
  Activities:

- Tour and safety demo.
- Practice handwashing.
  Assessment: Verbal safety quiz.
  Trainer Note: Emphasize hygiene.

Day 2: Prep and Inventory

Objective: Master prep and inventory.
Duration: 6–8 Hours
Key Components:

- Prep: chop trinity for Grillades & Grits.
- Inventory: FIFO, label low stock (e.g., crawfish).
- Storage: date and organize.
- Cleaning: sanitize workstations.
  Activities:
- Prep Maque Choux ingredients.
- Mock inventory check.
  Assessment: Practical prep test.
  Trainer Note: Focus on accuracy.

Day 3: Cooking Stations

Objective: Learn station techniques.
Duration: 6–8 Hours
Key Components:

- Stations: grill (Big Easy Steak), sauté (Chicken Piccata), fry (Chicken Fried Steak).
- Recipe: cook Shrimp & Grits.
- Timing: coordinate with expo.
- Plating: ensure consistency.
  Activities:
- Cook and plate per station.
- Station rotation.
  Assessment: Cooking and plating test.
  Trainer Note: Highlight speed.

Day 4: Advanced Techniques

Objective: Handle complex orders.
Duration: 6–8 Hours
Key Components:

- Special diets: gluten-free Jambalaya Pasta (basmati rice).
- High-volume: scale recipes.

- Emergencies: burns (cool, cover), equipment issues.
  Activities:
- Simulate rush with special orders.
- Scale a recipe.
  Assessment: Multitasking evaluation.
  Trainer Note: Reinforce adaptability.

Day 5: Event Prep

Objective: Prepare for events.
Duration: 6–8 Hours
Key Components:

- Event: Crawfish Boils (pre-order crawfish).
- Happy Hour: quick appetizer prep.
- Coordination: align with front-of-house.
  Activities:
- Mock Crawfish Boil prep.
- Batch appetizers.
  Assessment: Event prep test.
  Trainer Note: Emphasize teamwork.

Day 6: Team Coordination

Objective: Enhance teamwork.
Duration: 6–8 Hours
Key Components:

- Communication: verbal calls ("order in").
- Support: assist dishwashers.
- Conflict: report to Kitchen Manager.
  Activities:
- Simulate team shift.
- Role-play conflict.
  Assessment: Teamwork evaluation.
  Trainer Note: Build cohesion.

Day 7: Final Evaluation

Objective: Confirm readiness.
Duration: 6–8 Hours
Key Components:

- Full shift simulation.
- Review: safety, recipes, teamwork.

- Feedback session.
  Activities:
- Mock shift.
- Closing checklist.
  Assessment: Written test (90%), practical review.
  Trainer Note: Celebrate success.
  Probation: 90-day probationary period.

Kitchen Policies

Attendance and Punctuality

- Arrive 15 minutes early. Notify Kitchen Manager 4 hours in advance for absences.
- Unexcused absences/tardiness: verbal warning, written warning, termination.

Health and Safety

- **Food Safety:** 40°F cold, 165°F hot. Use gloves for ready-to-eat.
- **Sanitation:** Wash hands after raw handling; sanitize surfaces.
- **Recalls/Contamination:** Report to management; follow standard protocols.
- **Cross-Contamination:** Use new cutting boards for raw vs. cooked.
- **Pest Control:** Report to management; use designated agents.
- **Certification:** Texas Food Handler's Permit within 30 days.
- **Sanitizers:** Sani buckets required in each station.

Teamwork and Communication

- Use verbal calls during service. Assist colleagues during peaks.
- Report conflicts to Kitchen Manager.

Food Waste and Inventory

- Use FIFO; report low stock. Discard with approval.

Equipment Use

- Operate as trained (e.g., fryer 350°F). Clean immediately after use.
- Report malfunctions to Kitchen Manager.

Breaks and Staff Meals

- One 30-minute unpaid break per shift over 6 hours (manager-scheduled).
- One free meal per shift, consumed away from prep areas.

Customer Complaints

- Escalate to management for food quality or delay issues.

Smoking/Vaping

- No smoking or vaping indoors; eat away from prep areas.

Cell Phone Policy

- No phones in kitchen; use restaurant phone for emergencies. Violations may lead to discipline.

Operations

Station Setup

- Arrive in uniform; check prep list. Stock stations.

End-of-Shift Procedures

- Sanitize stations, store leftovers, sweep. Check out with Kitchen Manager.

Cleaning Schedules

- **Daily:** Morning (griddles), Evening (fryers, floors).
- **Weekly:** Monday (cooler), Friday (ovens).
- **Monthly:** Fryer filter changes.

Assessments

Food Safety

- Cold storage temperature?
- Cross-contamination prevention?
- Pest control protocol?

Recipe Knowledge

- Key ingredients in Shrimp & Grits?
- Prep for Chicken Fried Steak?
- Sauce for Cajun Colette?

Operations

- Fryer failure protocol?
- Crawfish Boil prep?
- Closing steps?

Teamwork

- Rush support?
- Verbal call for orders?
- Conflict reporting?

Conclusion

Congratulations

Congratulations on your training completion! You’re ready to embody “Fast and Flavorful” in Mouton’s kitchen. Keep the excellence alive!